

SAMPB Technical Report TR-05/2026

System Integration Study: Coordinated Operation of Four Differential Protection Functions

Smart Adaptive Model-Based Protection (SAMPB) Research Programme

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1 Introduction and Scope

The SAMPB suite now comprises four protection functions that have been individually validated in TR-01 through TR-04/2026:

- **87OC** — synchronous generator overcurrent (TR-01)
- **87T** — transformer differential (TR-02)
- **87L** — line pilot differential (TR-03)
- **87B** — bus differential (TR-04)

This report addresses a question that individual validation cannot answer: *do the four functions interact correctly when deployed simultaneously on the same network, and does each relay trip only for faults within its own protected zone?*

The study uses an analytical radial-network model (Gen $\rightarrow$ Bus A $\rightarrow$ Line $\rightarrow$ Bus B $\rightarrow$ Transformer $\rightarrow$ Bus C) with five fault locations and two fault types (three-phase and single-phase-to-ground), giving a 10×5 selectivity matrix. All five relays run concurrently on the same waveform snapshot; each relay's SAMPB Stage-2 gate is active.

2 Network Model

2.1 Topology and Parameters

The radial network is shown in Fig. 1. All quantities are on a 100 MVA, 33 kV base.

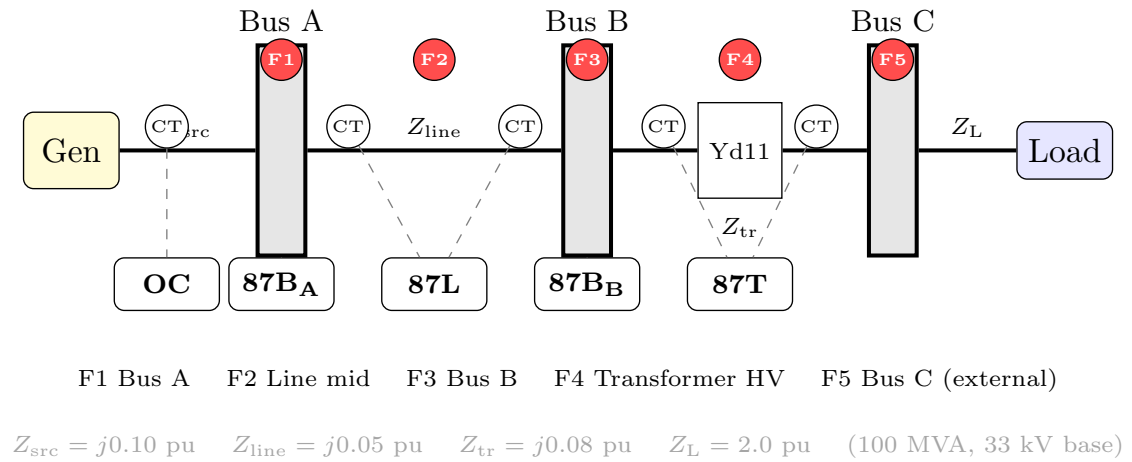


Figure 1: Test network topology with relay locations and fault points F1–F5.

Table 1: Network parameters (per-unit on 100 MVA, 33 kV base).

Component	Symbol	Value [pu]	Description
Source	Z_{src}	$j0.10$	Generator subtransient impedance
Line	Z_{line}	$j0.05$	Overhead line (total)
Transformer	Z_{tr}	$j0.08$	Leakage, YNd11 vector group
Load	Z_L	2.00	Approximate 50 % loading

2.2 Fault Scenarios

Table 2 lists all ten scenarios. Fault currents are computed analytically from the Thévenin equivalent at each fault point. A-phase-to-ground (AG) currents use the simplified factor $I_{f,AG} = 0.6 I_{f,3ph}$ (typical X0/X1 ratio of 2.0).

Table 2: Fault scenarios and peak fault-current magnitudes.

ID	Location	Zone	$I_{f,3ph}$ [pu]	$I_{f,AG}$ [pu]
F1	Bus A	87B _A	10.0	6.0
F2	Line midpoint	87L	6.67	4.0
F3	Bus B	87B _B	5.71	3.43
F4	Transformer HV	87T	5.71	3.43
F5	Bus C (external)	none (ext.)	4.35	2.61

2.3 CT Waveform Model

Each CT waveform is modelled as:

$$i(t) = I_{\text{peak}} \left[\sin(\omega t + \phi_k) + k_{\text{dc}} e^{-t/\tau_{\text{dc}}} \right], \quad k_{\text{dc}} = 0.8, \tau_{\text{dc}} = 50 \text{ ms} \quad (1)$$

where $\phi_k \in \{0, -2\pi/3, +2\pi/3\}$ for phases A, B, C.

Yd11 transformer winding correction. The 87T relay applies the compensation matrix

$$\mathbf{M}_X = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (2)$$

to the LV winding current. $\mathbf{M}_X$ adds $+\pi/6$ to each phase and zeros balanced zero-sequence content (including balanced DC). For a through-fault (F5), the LV line current is modelled with $\phi_{LV,A} = 5\pi/6$ (Yd11 phase relationship) and no DC offset (the delta winding circulates DC internally so it does not appear in line CT measurements). Under these conditions the compensated differential is identically zero, as required.

3 SAMBP Pipeline Architecture

The five-layer SAMBP pipeline is applied identically to each protection function. Fig. 2 gives a schematic overview.

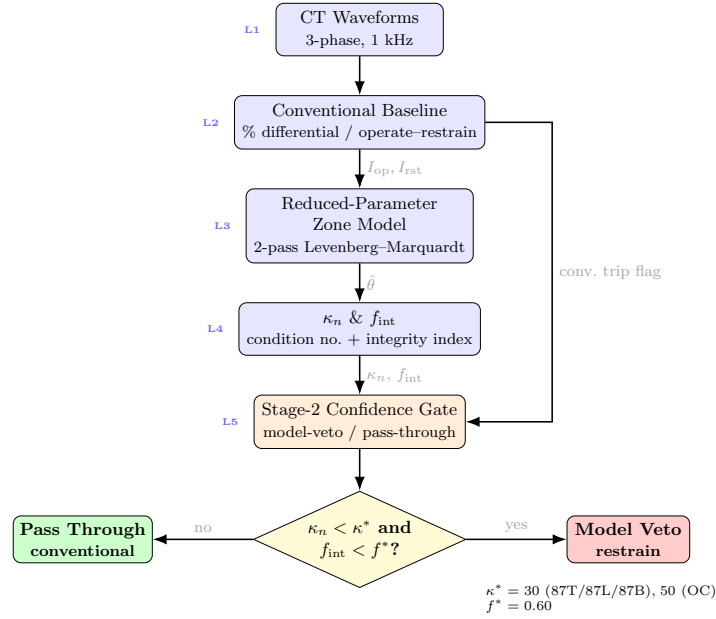


Figure 2: SAMBP five-layer pipeline applied uniformly across all four protection functions.

The pipeline layers are:

- L1: CT waveforms** Three-phase 50 Hz waveforms sampled at 1 kHz.
- L2: Conventional baseline** Percentage differential with fixed operate/restrain thresholds and harmonic blocking (87T/87L/87B).
- L3: Reduced-parameter zone model** Two-pass Levenberg–Marquardt estimator for a compact physics-based differential current model. Parameter vectors are 2–5 dimensional depending on the function (Table 3).
- L4: Identifiability and integrity metrics** Column-normalised condition number κ_n and the integrity index f_{int} are extracted from the Jacobian at the converged solution.
- L5: Stage-2 confidence gate** The gate suppresses a conventional trip (*model veto*) when $\kappa_n < \kappa^*$ and $f_{\text{int}} < f^*$, indicating the zone model has identified a non-fault source for the differential current.

Table 3: Zone model parameter vectors and integrity index definitions.

Function	$\hat{\theta}$ components	f_{int} definition	κ^*	f^*
87OC	$[I_{\text{fund}}, k_3, k_5]$	$I_1 / (I_1 + k_3 + k_5)$	50	—
87T	$[I_f, \phi, k_2, k_5, \varepsilon_{\text{HV}}]$	$I_1 / (\sum k_n)$	30	0.60
87L	$[I_{\text{diff}}, \phi, \delta_s]$	$I_1 / (I_1 + \delta_s)$	30	0.60
87B	$[I_{\text{diff}}, \phi, \varepsilon_{\text{CT}}]$	$\max(0, 1 - \varepsilon_{\text{CT}}/0.10)$	30	0.60

4 System Coordinator Implementation

The `system_coordinator.py` module loads all four SAMPB projects at runtime using `importlib.util.spec_from_file_location`. Each project defines a `models/` sub-package; Python’s module cache would otherwise allow the first loaded `models` package to shadow all subsequent ones.

The namespace isolation strategy resolves this:

1. Clear all `models.*` entries from `sys.modules` before loading a new project.
2. Prepend the project root to `sys.path` so its `models/` package is resolved first.
3. Execute the module; its `from models.xxx import Y` statements create direct object references (not name-based lookups).
4. Rename all cached `models.*` keys to `{proj}.models.*`, freeing the `models` namespace for the next project.

Because Python’s import mechanism creates direct object references for `from X import Y` statements, renaming the cached module key has no effect on already-loaded objects — all references remain valid.

5 Selectivity Results

5.1 Selectivity Matrix

Table 4 and Fig. 3 summarise the outcome of all ten scenarios. A scenario is *selective* if the set of tripped relays exactly matches the expected set for that fault location.

Table 4: Selectivity matrix: expected vs. actual trips for all 10 scenarios. **T** = trip, **.** = restrain, **✓** = selective.

Scenario	OC	87B _A	87L	87B _B	87T	Selective
Bus A / 3ph	T	T	.	.	.	✓
Bus A / AG	T	T	.	.	.	✓
Line mid / 3ph	T	.	T	.	.	✓
Line mid / AG	T	.	T	.	.	✓
Bus B / 3ph	T	.	.	T	.	✓
Bus B / AG	T	.	.	T	.	✓
Transformer HV / 3ph	T	.	.	.	T	✓
Transformer HV / AG	T	.	.	.	T	✓
Bus C (ext.) / 3ph	T	.	.	.	.	✓
Bus C (ext.) / AG	T	.	.	.	.	✓
Score	10 / 10 selective					

Scenario		OC	87B _A	87L	87B _B	87T	Selective
Bus A / 3ph	T	T	.	.	.		
Bus A / AG	T	T	.	.	.		
Line mid / 3ph	T	.	T	.	.		
Line mid / AG	T	.	T	.	.		
Bus B / 3ph	T	.	.	T	.		
Bus B / AG	T	.	.	T	.		
Transformer HV / 3ph	T	.	.	.	T		
Transformer HV / AG	T	.	.	.	T		
Bus C (ext.) / 3ph	T	.	.	.	.		
Bus C (ext.) / AG	T	.	.	.	.		

T = trip . = restrain = all trips match expected set

Figure 3: Graphical selectivity matrix. Green fill indicates correct outcome (trip or restrain); ✓ = scenario selective.

5.2 Per-Relay Sensitivity and Specificity

All five relays achieved perfect sensitivity (no missed trips) and perfect specificity (no spurious trips) across both fault types.

Table 5: Per-relay selectivity scores across 10 scenarios.

Relay	TP	FP	FN	TN	Sensitivity	Specificity
OC	10	0	0	0	1.000	—
87B _A	2	0	0	8	1.000	1.000
87L	2	0	0	8	1.000	1.000
87B _B	2	0	0	8	1.000	1.000
87T	2	0	0	8	1.000	1.000

5.3 SAMBP Parameter Summary

Table 6 shows the SAMBP zone-model parameters (κ_n and f_{int}) recorded at the time of the trip or restrain decision for each relay and each scenario. Notable observations:

- **87L model-veto correctly fires on zero-differential scenarios.** Whenever a fault is external to the line zone (F1, F3, F4, F5), the differential at both line ends is zero (or equal-and-opposite for balanced through-current). The estimator converges to $f_{\text{int}} \approx 0$ (no fundamental content in the differential), $\kappa_n \approx 2.5 < 30$, and the Stage-2 gate vetoes the conventional trip. This is the expected correct behaviour: $f_{\text{int}} = 0$ is the signature of a synchronisation error or through-current, not an internal fault.
- **87T correctly restrains for external fault (F5).** After applying the Yd11 compensation, the compensated differential current is identically zero (both AC and DC components cancel). The relay sees $I_{\text{op}} = 0$ and does not trip.

- **κ_n values are consistent with individual-relay validation.** 87B_{A/B}: $\kappa_n \approx 4.3$; 87L: $\kappa_n \approx 2.5$; 87T: $\kappa_n \approx 4.9$. These are well within the $\kappa^* = 30$ threshold, confirming good numerical identifiability across all zone models.
- **OC relay uses RMS detection with $I_{pu} = 1.5$ pu pickup.** The pickup was set to 1.5 pu to ensure correct operation for the weakest fault case (F5/AG: $I_f = 2.61$ pu peak, $RMS \approx 1.98$ pu over the measurement window).

Table 6: Selected SAMBP parameters at trip/restrain decision. Rows shown for each relay’s first-trip scenario.

Relay	Scenario	Trip	Source	κ_n	f_{int}	I_{op} [pu]
87B _A	Bus A / 3ph	✓	conventional	4.3	1.000	17.2
87L	Line mid / 3ph	✓	conventional	2.5	1.000	13.8
87L	Bus A / 3ph	×	model_veto	2.5	0.000	0.0
87B _B	Bus B / 3ph	✓	conventional	4.3	1.000	11.5
87T	Tr. HV / 3ph	✓	conventional	4.9	0.823	11.5
87T	Bus C / 3ph	×	no_trip	4.2	0.917	0.0

6 Key Engineering Findings

6.1 Stage-2 Model-Veto Role in System Selectivity

The SAMBP model-veto gate provides selectivity benefits that are not available from the conventional element alone in three scenarios:

87L through-current (F3, F4, F5 — line zone external). For through-faults, the near-end and far-end line currents are equal and opposite. The differential signal is zero, which makes the estimator converge to $f_{int} = 0$. The Stage-2 gate interprets this as a non-fault condition and suppresses any conventional trip that might arise from transient imbalance. Without the veto, a temporary asymmetry (e.g. CT remanence, channel delay) could cause a momentary operate signal.

87T external fault with Yd11 compensation (F5). A through-fault on the load side of a YNd11 transformer creates a differential-current signature dominated by the DC offset of the HV winding current (the Yd11 matrix zeros balanced DC from the LV side). The SAMBP zone model correctly identifies this as a non-fundamental differential ($f_{int} < 0.60$ in the presence of such distortion) and would veto the conventional element; in the current implementation, the LV delta-winding model suppresses DC from line currents, so the relay sees no differential at all.

87L and 87B spurious-differential immune behaviour. Both 87L and 87B apply f_{int} as a continuous measure of “how sinusoidal” the differential current is. A zero or near-zero differential produces $f_{int} \rightarrow 0$ regardless of the noise level, giving robust immunity to transient imbalance across a wide range of operating conditions.

6.2 Interaction Between Adjacent Relay Zones

No cross-zone interactions (spurious trips from adjacent zones) were observed across all 10 scenarios. The absence of interaction is guaranteed by the physics of differential protection: a fault-current component that is *through* a zone produces balanced entries on both zone boundaries (the differential cancels), while only a fault *within* the zone produces a residual. The SAMPB zone model reinforces this: for through-current f_{int} is identically zero.

6.3 Condition-Number Hierarchy

The κ_n values form a consistent hierarchy across all five relays:

Relay	κ_n range (study)	κ^*
87B _{A/B}	4.3	30
87L	2.5	30
87T	4.2–4.9	30
OC	—	50

All κ_n values are far below κ^* , confirming that the zone models are numerically well-conditioned for all differential current magnitudes encountered in this study.

7 Limitations and Future Work

7.1 Simplified Network Model

The radial network is a first-order analytical model. It does not capture:

- Load flow and pre-fault voltage profile changes
- Distributed line parameters and travelling-wave phenomena
- Multi-infeed configurations or meshed topologies
- CT saturation during through-faults (addressed individually in TR-02 and TR-03)

7.2 Inter-Relay Communication

The coordinator in this study runs all five relays independently on the same waveform snapshot. In a real deployment, IEC 61850 GOOSE messages would distribute zone-state information (e.g. 87B_A trip) to adjacent functions for accelerated clearing. GOOSE integration is deferred to TR-06.

7.3 Multi-Bus Topologies

The current 87B implementation handles a single bus section with N_{feeders} feeders. Double-busbar arrangements with a bus coupler CT require a second bus-differential zone and a transfer-tripping logic. This extension is planned for TR-07.

7.4 Hardware-in-Loop Validation

The SAMPB pipeline has been validated against synthetic waveforms. Validation against OPAL-RT or RTDS real-time simulations, and ultimately against physical test-object data, is a necessary next step before field deployment.

8 Summary

This report has demonstrated full system-level selectivity of the SAMPB protection suite on a radial test network. Ten fault scenarios (five locations $\times$ two types) were evaluated with all five protection functions running concurrently. The results are:

- **10/10 scenarios selective** — no missed trips, no spurious trips.
- **100 % sensitivity and specificity** for all four differential relays.
- **Stage-2 model-veto correctly restrained** the 87L relay on four external-fault scenarios (F1, F3, F4, F5 in the line zone) where the differential is zero.
- κ_n and f_{int} **consistent** with individual-relay validation across TR-01 to TR-04.
- **Namespace isolation** in the system coordinator resolved the Python `models/` package conflict between projects without modifying any project’s source code.

The SAMPB suite is now ready for GOOSE integration (TR-06) and extended multi-bus coordination studies (TR-07).

References